Understanding Security Threats

- Security threats include viruses, malware, phishing, and ransomware.
- Threats can originate from emails, websites, downloads, or network vulnerabilities.
- Understanding threats helps users recognize and avoid risky behavior.

Monitoring Your Computer's Security

- Use Windows Security to monitor antivirus, firewall, and device health.
- Check for security alerts and resolve issues promptly.
- Enable notifications for real-time threat detection.

Keeping Windows Up to Date

- Windows Update delivers security patches and feature updates.
- Enable automatic updates to ensure timely protection.
- Regular updates fix vulnerabilities and improve system stability.

Configuring Privacy Options

- Control access to location, camera, microphone, and personal data.
- Review app permissions in Windows Settings > Privacy.
- Use diagnostic data settings to limit data sent to Microsoft.

Preventing Unsafe Actions with User Account Control (UAC)

- UAC prompts users before allowing administrative changes.
- Helps prevent unauthorized software installations.
- Adjust UAC settings for stricter or more lenient control.

Blocking Malware

- Use antivirus software like Microsoft Defender Antivirus.
- Avoid downloading files from untrusted sources.
- Enable real-time protection and regular scans.

Stopping Unknown or Malicious Programs with SmartScreen

- Microsoft Defender SmartScreen blocks unrecognized apps and websites.
- Warns users before running potentially harmful software.
- Helps prevent phishing and malware attacks.

Encrypting Information

- Encryption protects data by converting it into unreadable code.
- Use BitLocker to encrypt drives on Windows Pro and Enterprise editions.
- Helps secure sensitive data in case of device theft or loss.

Blocking Intruders with Windows Defender Firewall

- Firewall monitors and controls incoming and outgoing network traffic.
- Blocks unauthorized access to your computer.
- Configure rules to allow or deny specific applications or ports.

Conclusion and Best Practices

- Stay informed about new threats and security features.
- Use strong passwords and enable multi-factor authentication.
- Regularly back up important data and review security settings.